

CPC251 Lecture 4 — Backpropagation

Backpropagation computes the gradient of the loss with respect to each weight by applying the chain rule backward through the network.

Step 1 — Forward pass

Compute activations layer by layer and store them.

Step 2 — Backward pass

Propagate the error signal backward, one layer at a time.

Step 3 — Weight update

Gradient descent updates each weight using the computed gradient.

Symbol	Meaning
L	loss
w	weight